JJJ-P-1865
July 5, 1974
(see 6.4)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PEPPERS, PICKLED, CHERRY AND JALAPENO

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for cherry peppers and jalapeno peppers for use by all Federal agencies.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and styles. The product covered by this specification shall be of the following types and styles, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I - Cherry (hot)

Style (a) Fresh
Style (b) Fermented (cured)

Type II - Jalapeno

Style (a) Fresh
Style (b) Fermented (cured)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-C-29	-	Canned, Subsistence Items, Packaging and Packing Of
PPP-C-96	-	Cans, Metal, .28 Gage and Lighter
PPP-G-460	-	Glass Containers, One Gallon Capacity and Smaller for Other than Medicinal Products; Packaging and Packing Of

FSC 8950

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

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Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-668 - Sanitary Standards for Food Plants

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

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U.S. Department of Agriculture

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Information Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Peppers. Peppers of the specified type and style shall be properly prepared from clean, sound peppers and, unless otherwise specified shall be of the latest season's crop. The peppers shall be whole, with stems, free from damage caused by hail, scars, sunburn, disease, insects, mechanical or other means.

3.1.2 Salt. Salt shall be clean white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agent. Iodized salt shall not be used.

3.1.3 Vinegar. Vinegar used shall be cider vinegar or distilled vinegar. Cider vinegar, if used, shall be clear, bright, brownish yellow in color, free from cloudiness, sediment and floating particles and shall have a clean, fruity odor. Distilled vinegar shall be spirit, distilled, or grain vinegar and shall be clear, bright, transparent, without color and free from any pronounced odor other than that of acetic acid.

3.1.4 Artificial coloring. Artificial coloring shall not be used.

3.1.5 Preservatives. Unless otherwise specified, type I may have any suitable preservative added which is permitted under the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.

3.1.6 Seasonings and vegetable oil. For type II products, seasonings (onion, garlic, spices) and vegetable oil may be added.

3.2 Processing. The peppers shall be properly washed to remove soil, spray residue and foreign matter. They shall be sorted to remove diseased and seriously damaged units in accordance with good commercial practice. The product shall be sufficiently processed to assure preservation in either metal or glass containers as specified.

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3.3 Finished product.

3.3.1 Type I. Cherry peppers may be whole green or mixed green and red hot cherry peppers of similar varietal characteristics, packed in a vinegar and salt brine with or without preservative. For mixed peppers, the red peppers shall not exceed 20 percent by count.

3.3.2 Type II. Jalapeno peppers shall be whole green, fully developed Jalapeno peppers of similar varietal characteristics packed in a vinegar and salt brine with or without seasonings and vegetable oil. The peppers shall be at least 1/2 inch in diameter and at least 1-1/2 inches in length. Diameter means the greatest dimension measured at right angles to the longitudinal axis. Length means the greatest overall length measured in a straight line parallel to the longitudinal axis, exclusive of the stem.

3.3.3 Defects. The finished product shall be free from serious defects. Serious defects are those which affect the appearance or eating quality of the peppers.

3.3.4 Character. The peppers shall possess a firm texture which is not noticeably soft and is characteristic of properly prepared peppers.

3.3.5 Fill of container. The peppers shall be covered or practically covered by the packing medium.

3.4 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.5 Workmanship. The product shall be prepared in accordance with part 128 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 21, Human Foods; Current Good Manufacturing, processing, packing or holding. In addition, for Military agencies, the product shall be processed in establishments meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-668.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. The supplier is responsible for meeting all the provisions of the specification prior to submission of supplies to the Government for acceptance. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed herein using his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government.

4.2 Preacceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection).

4.2.1 Civil agencies. When specified (see 6.1), inspection of plants producing the product will be conducted upon request of the contracting officer

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to the appropriate Government inspection agency. Award of contracts will be limited to establishments known to maintain proper sanitary conditions or which have received prior sanitary approval recommended by the inspection agency.

4.2.2 Military agencies. The product shall be rejected if produced in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.5.

4.3 Acceptance inspection.

4.3.1 Condition inspection of containers. When inspection of product for quality and condition is performed by the U.S. Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply. (For applicable criteria governing inspection of containers for the Military, see 4.3.5).

4.3.2 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.3 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.3.1 Ingredients. Conformance to identity (kind) requirements shall be ascertained by examination of labels, invoices or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically, as necessary, to determine conformance to condition requirements as may be contained in the pertinent requirement paragraph. The sample unit shall be approximately 1 pound (1 pint if liquid) of ingredient derived from a primary container. The sample size shall be five. In the event a lot consists of less than five containers, a sample unit shall be extracted from each container in the lot. Nonconformance with identity requirements or one or more sample units not conforming to condition requirements shall indicate an unacceptable ingredient and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved finished product.

4.3.3.2 Testing of jar lids and cans. Jar lids and cans shall be tested for tin plate in accordance with 4.4.2.1. The sample unit shall be one jar lid or 1 - 4x4 inch section of can body w/lid. The sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-1. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of jar lids or cans. Test requirements shall be an average requirement and test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.01 lb/base box. Testing of can label and can coating (when required) shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and TT-C-495 respectively, and shall be performed on the same cans submitted for tin plate test. A test failure shall indicate an unacceptable component and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

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4.3.4 Process examination. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) examination shall be performed to the extent necessary to determine conformance to 3.1 and 3.2 as concerns proper cleaning, screening and processing of peppers. Nonconformance with required procedure shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

4.3.5 Examination of end item. Examinations of end item shall be in accordance with tables II through IV and 4.3.5.1 through 4.3.5.3. Sampling plans for the aforementioned tables shall be in accordance with table I. The acceptable quality levels (AQLS) shall be expressed as defects per hundred units for table III and percent defective for tables II and IV.

TABLE I. Sampling plans

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLS Major	AQLS Minor	AQLS Total
II	S-3	1 filled jar or can	Jars or cans	--	2.5	--
III	S-2	1 filled jar or can	Jars or cans	1.0	--	6.5
IV	S-2	1 labeled jar	Jars	--	2.5	--

TABLE II. Examination of drained weight of peppers 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Type II peppers less than 62-1/2 ounces
202	Type I peppers less than 70-1/2 ounces

1/ Empty contents of container on U.S. No. 8 sieve and allow to drain at approximately 17°-20° angle from horizontal for two minutes before weighing. Weigh peppers only.

2/ Weighing device shall be calibrated in not more than 1/2-ounce increments. Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicates a lot average drained weight of less than 64 ounces for type II and 72 ounces for type I.

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TABLE III. Examination of product

Category		Defect 1/
Major	Minor	
101		Not type peppers specified
102		Brine not covering or nearly covering peppers
103		More than 5% (to nearest unit) by count have serious defects which adversely affect appearance or eating quality
104		More than 5% (to nearest unit) by count have a soft texture
	201	Type I mixed peppers have more than 20% (to nearest unit) by count of red peppers
	202	More than 5% (to nearest unit) by count of type II peppers not in conformance to size requirements 2/

1/ Presence of foreign material (e.g. wood, glass, paint, insects, filth, etc.) shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Measuring device shall be calibrated in 1/16 inch increments.

TABLE IV. Examination for label adhesive 1/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Displacement of label

1/ Applicable to level A packed jars. See 4.4.1.2 for procedure.

4.3.5.1 Examination of primary containers. Examination of cans and jars for condition and labeling shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers. In addition, cans shall be examined for interior enamel and vacuum in accordance with the applicable quality assurance provisions of PPP-C-29.

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4.3.5.2 Examination of packing, marking and shipping containers. Examinations shall be in accordance with the applicable quality assurance provisions of PPP-G-460 for glass containers and PPP-C-29 for cans.

4.3.5.3 Examination of unit loads. Unit loads shall be examined in accordance with the criteria in MIL-L-35078.

4.4 Examination and test methods. Examination and test procedures which differ from those specified herein, unless otherwise excepted, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum such quality assurance, the supplier will use the procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to examination or test results, the procedures specified herein will govern.

4.4.1 Examination procedures.

4.4.1.1 Vacuum. Procedure for determining vacuum shall be in accordance with PPP-C-29.

4.4.1.2 Water-resistant examination for label adhesive. The label adhesive shall be examined for water-resistance as follows: Submerge glass container with label affixed into room temperature water for 4 hours. Remove from water and remove excess water by blotting with paper towel. Press finger firmly against the label (in an area where adhesive has been applied) and move finger (still pressed against the label) towards the bottom of the bottle. Displacement of the label indicates failure to meet the requirement.

4.4.2 Test procedures.

4.4.2.1 Tinplate weight. Tinplate weight shall be determined by any method specified in PPP-C-96.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1 or 5.1.2, as applicable.

5.1.1 Cherry peppers, level C. Sufficient cherry peppers to obtain a drained weight of 72 ounces shall be packaged in brine in a one-gallon capacity glass jar. A minus tolerance of 1-1/2 ounces will be allowed in any individual container, provided the average drained weight of the jars, inspected in accordance with table II, is not less than 72 ounces. The jar shall be provided with a metal screw cap constructed of not less than nominal 1.35/0.25-pound tinplate

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per base box. The cap shall be coated on the inside with an enamel suitable for the product and shall be provided with a wax or polyethylene coated liner. The cap shall be secured in place with a shrink-on cellulose band or a strip of pressure sensitive tape which overlaps itself not less than 3/4-inch.

5.1.2 Jalapeno peppers. Jalapeno peppers shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.2.1 Level A. Sufficient jalapeno peppers to obtain a drained weight of 64 ounces shall be packaged in a size 603 by 700, open-top style, round, metal can with soldered side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. A minus tolerance of 1-1/2 ounces will be allowed in any individual container provided the average drained weight of the cans, inspected in accordance with table II, is not less than 64 ounces. The can shall be made throughout from not less than nominal 1.35/0.25-pound tinplate per base box (see 4.4.2.1) and shall be coated overall on the inside with an enamel suitable for the product. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating complying with type I of TT-C-495. The can shall show a vacuum when examined in accordance with 4.4.1.1.

5.1.2.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.2.1, except that cans with or without commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1 or 5.2.2, as applicable.

5.2.1 Cherry peppers, levels A, B, and C. Cherry peppers shall be packed in accordance with the level A, B, or C requirements of PPP-G-460, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.2 Jalapeno peppers, levels A, B, and C. Jalapeno peppers shall be packed in accordance with the level A, B, or C requirements of PPP-C-29 for size 603 by 700 cans, as specified (see 6.1).

5.3 Unit loads. When specified, the product shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1).

5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Glass jars. Labeling shall comply with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. For level A pack the glass jars shall be labeled with a hard or varnished paper label affixed with a water-resistant adhesive. The label shall be examined in accordance with procedures of 4.4.1.2.

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5.4.2 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497.

5.4.3 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.4 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. Notes

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the perferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and style required (see 1.2.1).
(c) When plant sanitation inspection is required by Civil agencies (see 4.2.1).
(d) When process examination is not required by Civil agencies (see 4.3.4).
(e) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Type and class of unit load, when unit loading is specified (see 5.3).

6.2 Type II. Jalapeno peppers packed in tin cans have a shelf life of 15 months from date of pack.

6.3 Selection of levels (Military agencies). Based on conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15, NAVSUPINST 4030.28, AFR 71-6, MCO 4030.14 or DSAR 4145.7, as applicable.

6.4 Supersession data. This specification includes the requirements of Interim Purchase Description IP/DES 17-0, dated 18 June 70.

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